

Day 44 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Social Problems: Population, Education, Health, Employment, Poverty (with TN Human Development Indicators)

READING MATERIAL

Covers unemployment and poverty as social problems, and Tamil Nadu's standing on Human Development Indicators (literacy, health, employment) compared to the rest of India. Several facts here are explicitly time-bound (tied to a specific year's data) — flagged so they aren't mistaken for permanent facts.

Q: Real exam (Assertion-Reason): Is unemployment a major social problem, and does financial-aid provision directly EXPLAIN why it causes sickness/disorganization?

A: Both statements are TRUE — unemployment IS a major social problem causing sickness and personal/family/community disorganization, AND social provisions for financial aid do alleviate the suffering unemployment entails — but a real exam confirmed the second statement is NOT the correct EXPLANATION of the first; they're both true facts that don't have that specific cause-effect relationship to each other.

Q: Real exam: Which state had the highest unemployment percentage during 2022-23 (among Kerala, Haryana, Punjab, Tamil Nadu)?

A: Kerala — confirmed by a real exam question. (Note: this is a specific year's snapshot, not a permanent ranking — unemployment rates fluctuate yearly.)

Q: Real exam: What was Tamil Nadu's Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) in higher education during 2021-2022?

A: 47 percent — confirmed by a real exam question. (Also a specific year's figure, useful as a benchmark but expected to change in later editions of the same statistic.)

Q: Real exam: As per the 2011 census, how do The Nilgiris, Chennai, Thoothukudi, and Kanyakumari rank by literacy rate (highest to lowest)?

A: Kanyakumari (highest), then Chennai, then Thoothukudi, then The Nilgiris (lowest among these four) — confirmed by a real exam question. Kanyakumari is generally known to have the highest literacy rate among all Tamil Nadu districts.

Q: How does Tamil Nadu generally compare to other Indian states on the Human Development Index (HDI) and related indicators?

A: Tamil Nadu typically ranks among India's top 5 states on HDI (rankings vary by year/source, roughly 3rd-5th), behind Kerala (which consistently ranks 1st nationally on HDI). TN performs particularly well on health indicators (lower infant/child mortality than the national average) and is among the top 3 states by per-capita income and GDP contribution.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Assertion [A]: Unemployment is a major social problem causing sickness and family/community disorganization. Reason [R]: Social financial-aid provisions alleviate the suffering unemployment causes. Choose the correct option.

- A. [A] is true; [R] is false
- B. Both [A] and [R] are true, and [R] is the correct explanation of [A]
- C. Both [A] and [R] are true, but [R] is NOT the correct explanation of [A] ✓**
- D. [A] is false; [R] is true

Explanation: Both true, but [R] does not explain [A]. [hard, question-bank-2026]

2. Which state had the highest unemployment percentage during 2022-23, among Kerala, Haryana, Punjab, and Tamil Nadu?

- A. Kerala ✓**
- B. Haryana
- C. Punjab
- D. Tamil Nadu

Explanation: Kerala. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. Tamil Nadu's Gross Enrollment Ratio (GER) in higher education during 2021-2022 was:

- A. 45 percent
- B. 46 percent
- C. 47 percent ✓**
- D. 48 percent

Explanation: 47 percent. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. As per the 2011 census, which Tamil Nadu district among the following had the HIGHEST literacy rate?

- A. The Nilgiris
- B. Chennai
- C. Thoothukudi

D. Kanyakumari ✓

Explanation: Kanyakumari. [medium, question-bank-2026]

5. As per the 2011 census, arrange these districts by literacy rate from highest to lowest: The Nilgiris, Chennai, Thoothukudi, Kanyakumari.

A. Kanyakumari, Chennai, Thoothukudi, The Nilgiris ✓

- B. Chennai, Kanyakumari, The Nilgiris, Thoothukudi
- C. The Nilgiris, Thoothukudi, Chennai, Kanyakumari
- D. Thoothukudi, Kanyakumari, Chennai, The Nilgiris

Explanation: Kanyakumari, Chennai, Thoothukudi, The Nilgiris. [hard, question-bank-2026]

6. Which state consistently ranks 1st nationally on the Human Development Index (HDI)?

- A. Tamil Nadu
- B. Kerala ✓**
- C. Punjab
- D. Haryana

Explanation: Kerala. [easy, web-research]

7. On health indicators (e.g., infant/child mortality), how does Tamil Nadu generally compare to the national average?

- A. Worse than the national average
- B. Better than the national average ✓**
- C. Exactly at the national average
- D. No comparable data exists

Explanation: Better than the national average. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Puzzles

READING MATERIAL

Puzzles is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills. The genre overlaps with Logical Reasoning, so this topic focuses on archetypes NOT already covered there: comparison chains, age puzzles, family-relation puzzles, and linear seating arrangements — all extremely common TNPSC puzzle shapes.

Q: Method — comparison chain (not all four compared directly, must chain through clues): D is taller than C but not as tall as B. C is taller than A. Who is the tallest?

A: Chain it: $B > D > C > A$. So B is the tallest. The key technique: write each clue as an inequality, then merge them into one ordered chain rather than trying to compare all pairs mentally.

Q: Method — classic age puzzle: A father is 4 times as old as his son. In 20 years, he will be twice as old as his son. Find their current ages.

A: Let son's current age = x , father = $4x$. In 20 years: father = $4x+20$, son = $x+20$. Condition: $4x+20 = 2(x+20) \rightarrow 4x+20 = 2x+40 \rightarrow 2x=20 \rightarrow x=10$. Son is 10, father is 40.

Q: Method — family-relation puzzle: Pointing to a photograph, a man says, 'She is the daughter of my mother's only son.' How is the woman in the photo related to the man?

A: His daughter. 'My mother's only son' = the man himself (since he's referring to his own mother, and he's an only son). So 'her father' = the man, making the woman his daughter.

Q: Method — linear seating arrangement: Five friends P, Q, R, S, T sit in a row. Q is immediately to the right of P. R is at one end. S is between Q and T. T is not adjacent to P. Find the order.

A: Work from the most fixed clue first: R is at an end — try R at the left end. P-Q must be adjacent with Q right of P, and S is between Q and T, with T not adjacent to P. Testing R,P,Q,S,T: P-Q adjacent ✓, S between Q&T ✓, T not adjacent to P (T is at position 5, P at position 2, not adjacent) ✓, R at an end ✓. Order: R, P, Q, S, T.

Q: Method — distribution/sharing puzzle: A sum of money is divided among A, B, and C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets thrice as much as C. If C gets ₹600, find the total sum.

A: $C=600$. $B=3 \times 600=1800$. $A=2 \times 1800=3600$. Total = $3600+1800+600 = 6000$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. P is shorter than Q but taller than R. Q is shorter than S. Who is the tallest?

- A. P
- B. Q
- C. R
- D. S ✓**

Explanation: Chain: $S > Q > P > R$. S is tallest. [medium, authored]

2. A mother is 3 times as old as her daughter. In 15 years, she will be twice as old as her daughter. Find the daughter's current age.

- A. 10
- B. 12
- C. 15 ✓**
- D. 18

Explanation: Daughter= x , mother= $3x$. $3x+15=2(x+15) \rightarrow 3x+15=2x+30 \rightarrow x=15$. [medium, authored]

3. Pointing to a man, a woman says, 'He is the son of my father's only daughter.' If the woman has no siblings, how is the man related to her?

- A. Her son ✓**
- B. Her brother
- C. Her nephew
- D. Her father

Explanation: 'My father's only daughter' = the woman herself (she has no siblings). So the man is her son. [medium, authored]

4. ₹7,000 is divided among A, B, C so that A gets twice as much as B, and B gets twice as much as C. Find C's share.

- A. ₹1,000 ✓**
- B. ₹1,200

C. ₹1,500

D. ₹2,000

Explanation: Let $C=x$, $B=2x$, $A=4x$. Total= $7x=7000 \rightarrow x=1,000$. [medium, authored]

5. Four friends sit in a row. B is immediately right of A. C is at the left end. D is not adjacent to A. Find the correct order.

A. C, A, B, D ✓

B. A, B, C, D

C. C, D, A, B

D. D, A, B, C

Explanation: C at left end; A-B adjacent with B right of A; D not adjacent to A. Order C,A,B,D satisfies all three conditions. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "Sir Isaac Newton — The Ingenious Scientist" — Nathaniel Hawthorne

READING MATERIAL

A biographical sketch of the young Isaac Newton's childhood inventiveness, written by the American author Nathaniel Hawthorne (from his 1851 collection 'True Stories from History and Biography'), focusing on Newton's early mechanical talent before his famous scientific discoveries.

Q: Where was Isaac Newton born, and who took care of him after his mother remarried?

A: Woolsthorpe (England). His GRANDMOTHER took care of him after his mother remarried — confirmed by a real exam question. (His stepfather was a CLERGYMAN.)

Q: What was one of Isaac's remarkable childhood talents, and what was one of the first mechanical devices he made?

A: Building mechanical tools and devices. One of his first such devices was a WATER-CLOCK (a clock powered by water).

Q: What did young Isaac construct after studying a nearby windmill, and what (unusual detail) did he use as the 'miller' inside his model?

A: A model windmill. He used a MOUSE as the miller inside his miniature windmill.

Q: What were the sails of Isaac's model windmill made of, and what would happen if grains of wheat were put into its little hopper?

A: The sails were neatly made of linen, and whirled round swiftly in a draught of air. Grains of wheat put into the hopper would soon be converted into snow-white flour — demonstrating the working model's realism.

Q: What was the purpose of the sun-dial Isaac made, and how did he measure the strength of the wind as a child?

A: The sun-dial was made to tell the time during sunny days. He measured wind strength by JUMPING AGAINST the wind.

Q: Why did Isaac's mother want him to leave school at age 14, and how did Newton describe his own knowledge near the end of his life?

A: To help manage the family farm. Despite his monumental discoveries, Newton famously described his knowledge as LIMITED compared to the vast truth that still lay undiscovered (a famous note of scientific humility).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Isaac Newton was born in:

- A. Cambridge
- B. London
- C. North Witham
- D. Woolsthorpe ✓**

Explanation: Woolsthorpe. [medium, web-research]

2. After his mother remarried, who took care of young Isaac Newton?

- A. His uncle
- B. His father
- C. His grandmother ✓**
- D. A neighbor

Explanation: His grandmother. [medium, question-bank-2024]

3. What was the occupation of Isaac Newton's stepfather?

- A. Farmer
- B. Clockmaker
- C. Teacher
- D. Clergyman ✓**

Explanation: Clergyman. [medium, web-research]

4. What type of clock did young Isaac invent?

- A. A wind-powered clock
- B. A water-clock ✓**
- C. A solar-powered clock
- D. A pendulum clock

Explanation: A water-clock. [medium, web-research]

5. What did Isaac construct after studying a nearby windmill?

A. A clock

B. A model windmill ✓

C. A mechanical crane

D. A solar panel

Explanation: A model windmill. [easy, web-research]

6. What did Isaac use as the 'miller' in his miniature windmill?

A. A small doll

B. A mouse ✓

C. A wooden block

D. A toy soldier

Explanation: A mouse. [hard, web-research]

7. What was the purpose of the sun-dial that Isaac made?

A. To tell the time at night

B. To tell time during sunny days ✓

C. To measure distance

D. To determine wind speed

Explanation: To tell time during sunny days. [medium, web-research]

8. How did Isaac measure the strength of the wind as a child?

A. By jumping against the wind ✓

B. By building a wind gauge

C. By using a compass

D. By observing tree movements

Explanation: By jumping against the wind. [medium, web-research]

9. Why did Isaac's mother want him to leave school at age 14?

A. To become a clockmaker

B. To help manage the farm ✓

C. To join the military

D. To pursue mathematics full-time

Explanation: To help manage the farm. [medium, web-research]

10. How did Newton describe his own knowledge near the end of his life?

A. As complete and satisfactory

B. As limited compared to the truth that still lies undiscovered ✓

C. As vast and limitless

D. As sufficient for his time

Explanation: As limited compared to undiscovered truth. [hard, web-research]